

The medical error case I researched was Jessica Powell who had a double above the knee amputation after allegedly receiving an dose of Vasopressin at 2.5x the maximum dose for 40 hours, which significantly restricted blood flow to Powell's lower leg and feet. When she was 28, she collapsed at home due to a stomach virus and hormone deficiency disease and diagnosed with sepsis and shock. This case drew attention because the scenario is one that occurs commonly in hospitals where Vasopressors are routinely used to treat shock and ICU teams are making rapid decisions. This would be categorized as a treatment error in the dosage of a drug. According to the NCC MERP index, this would likely be under category G because an error occurred that may have contributed/resulted in permanent potential harm for Ms. Powell due to the double amputation after receiving excess medication. Three physicians (Joe Morgan, James Palazzolo, and Thomas Ungarino) were named in the lawsuit in addition to the Albany Pulmonary and Critical Care Associates and Albany Vascular Specialist Center and they all denied wrongdoing and claimed they meant to administer care as they did and Dr. Ungarino even argued that the defendant's legs were already irreversibly injured before admission to the hospital. Despite Ms. Powell claiming that Dr. Morgan failed to address complications as the Vasopressin was withdrawn. Part of the error I believe was caused by feeling hurried due to Powell being critically ill and her life being in danger. Based on the coverage of the trial, the jury assigned 50% fault to the treatment center (Morgan and Albany Vascular Specialist Center and 50% fault to Palazzolo, Ungarino and Albany Pulmonary and Critical Care Associates. Based on the coverage of the case, the physicians involved attempted to rationalize the error rather than perform root cause analysis to uncover the cause of the problem and adding steps to prevent similar situations from occurring in the future.